

invented this detonator. Shouldn't he get a Nobel prize for all this? A stick of dynamite (0.19 kg, 75% nitroglycerin) contains around 1 million Joules of energy, enough to blow up your car. Dynamite has been increasingly replaced by Semtex and C4 for military usage. It's still used for blasting gold and diamond mines in South Africa.

Dynamo

A powercut for a couple of hours is enough to frustrate the living daylight out of us. Well, then try and imagine life without usable electricity. Thanks to Michael Faraday and his law of induction today we live in a world where generation and usage of electricity is fairly straightforward. We owe this to the invention of the dynamo. The word "dynamo", derived from the Greek word for power, is now used to refer to an electrical generator that produces direct current with the use of a commutator. The dynamo, like any other generator is used to produce electricity from mechanical energy. The first dynamo however, was invented by Michael Faraday in 1831; it didn't use a commutator and generated DC current producing very low voltages.

However, Tesla's theory that the future of electricity lied in AC (Alternating Current) rather than DC – as thought by his rival Edison – turned out to be right. This effectively doomed the dynamo to minor science experiments. Dynamos were quickly replaced thanks to the inefficiencies of the commutator, and because converting AC to DC was a more effective

